

"JETRO Business Brief" 2026/08/21

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【ASIA-OCEANIA】

China's Ministry of Foreign Affairs makes statement on US response to AI cooperation initiative, asserting countries' right to choose partners (China, US)

●Beijing

China's Ministry of Justice deems EU's FSR investigation into JD.com as unlawful extraterritorial jurisdiction, prohibits cooperation with investigation (China, EU)

●Beijing

China announces support measures to boost consumption in county-level jurisdictions, promoting expansion of domestic demand (China)

●Beijing

Guangdong Province restructures minimum wage into three categories with increases, to be implemented from September 1 (China)

●Guangzhou

Thailand's second quarter GDP growth rate slows to 1.9% year-on-year (Thailand)

●Bangkok

Indonesia's first half 2026 trade surplus declines over 80% compared to same period previous year (Indonesia)

●Jakarta

India's life insurance market in July records 20% increase in new policy premiums, driven by state-owned insurer LIC's group insurance (India)

●Mumbai

Gujarat State Government holds briefing session for "Vibrant Gujarat Global Summit 2027" (India)

●Ahmedabad

【NORTH AMERICA AND LATIN AMERICA】

German Innio expands power generation engine production in Wisconsin, US with investment exceeding \$300 million (US, Germany)

●Chicago

US Treasury Department publishes 2025 CFIUS report, showing trend toward stricter screening of transactions raising national security concerns (US)

●New York

US major retailers announce second quarter results, tariff refunds boost profits (US)

● New York

Survey shows concerns about AI use expansion among US youth exceed expectations, according to think tank research (US)

● Survey Department, Americas Division

Power shortage concerns intensify in Venezuela, government calls on citizens to participate in energy conservation plan (Venezuela)

● Caracas

Chile's second quarter GDP growth rate comes in at negative 0.2%, falling below market expectations, with some pointing to recession entry following two consecutive quarters of negative growth (Chile)

● Santiago

【EUROPE, RUSSIA, CENTRAL ASIA AND CAUCASUS】

Automotive industry employment reaches lowest level since 2005, announces German Federal Statistical Office (Germany)

● Munich

Romania completely halts operation of country's only nuclear power plant due to Danube River water level decline (Romania, Japan)

● Bucharest

【MIDDLE EAST AND AFRICA】

President Trump announces strengthening of economic pressure on Iran, UAE implements measures to halt Iran-related transactions (US, Iran, UAE, Israel, China, Russia, Pakistan, Turkey, Iraq)

● Tel Aviv

Japan's July trade with Middle East shows year-on-year increase in both exports and imports (Japan, Middle East, UAE, Saudi Arabia, Oman, Kuwait, Qatar, Iran, US)

● Survey Department, Middle East and Africa Division

46th SADC Summit discusses critical mineral resources and agricultural industrialization (South Africa)

● Johannesburg